BERNSTEIN
SOCIETE GENERALE GROUP

12 October 2026


Richard J. Clarke, FCA
+44 20 7676 6850
richard.clarke@bernsteinsg.com


Niall Mitchelson
+44 20 7676 7144
niall.mitchelson@bernsteinsg.com


Lasith Siriwardana
+44 20 7550 2191
lasith.siriwardana@bernsteinsg.com

Global Hotels & Leisure

Airbnb Inc

Rating

Outperform

Price Target

ABNB **217.00 USD**

Airbnb: Pulling the "biggest lever". Sizing dynamic pricing

Airbnb's fall update included the official rollout of dynamic pricing. CEO Brian Chesky described pricing at Q2 results as "one of the biggest single levers for growth" and "many multiples bigger than RNPL." Hosts can now allow Airbnb to automatically adjust prices within an approved range, raising or lowering rates in response to changes in demand and competitive supply. Accounting for a reasonable uplift in host revenue and the currently modest penetration of dynamic pricing (~40% of listings), we believe Airbnb's proprietary pricing tool could ultimately provide a **~5-7% revenue tailwind**.

Airbnb is well positioned to offer a differentiated solution. Dynamic pricing tools already exist, but third-party providers typically charge subscription fees (~$20/month) and rely on incomplete or scraped datasets. Airbnb's product is free for now, and benefits from access to vast volumes of real-time and historical transaction data. We therefore expect it to drive meaningful improvements in host economics by reducing the inefficiencies associated with static pricing. If Airbnb can increase penetration from ~40% today to 70% over time, particularly among less tech-savvy hosts, we estimate the product could generate a **mid-single-digit revenue tailwind**. Should realized host gains approach the 25% levels advertised by third-party providers, the revenue opportunity could be in the **high-single-digit range**.

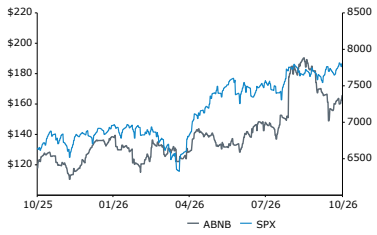
The key challenge will be trust, but the longer-term direction resembles a franchise model. Adoption is unlikely to happen overnight, as hosts will need confidence that Airbnb is optimising for their economics rather than improving conversion on Airbnb at the expense of pricing elsewhere. Over time, we expect Airbnb to expand beyond pricing into a broader suite of host services, including design, property management and potentially hardware solutions such as smart locks. The end state increasingly resembles a hotel franchise model, where Airbnb becomes more deeply embedded in the operation of the asset and more closely aligned with hosts in maximising revenue. In our view, that should create more loyal supply, improve listing quality and strengthen Airbnb's competitive position in a future where AI agents may increasingly commoditise distribution.

Close Date	8 Oct 2026
ABNB Close Price (USD)	163.23
Price Target (USD)	217.00
Upside/(Downside)	33%
52-Week Range	193.45/110.81
SPX	7,811.54
FYE	Dec
Div Yield	NA
Market Cap (USD) (M)	99,096
EV (USD) (M)	89,543

Performance	YTD	1M	6M	12M
Absolute (%)	21.9	(2.4)	28.1	37.7
SPX (%)	14.1	2.3	14.5	16.0
Relative (%)	7.8	(4.7)	13.7	21.8

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

Price Performance, 1YR



Investment Implications

We rate Airbnb Outperform. We see pricing as part of the broad shift to maximising revenue growth but also tying hosts to the platform, an increasingy valuable strategy.

Adjusted EPS	F25A	F26E	F27E
ABNB (USD)	4.03	5.37	6.58

Financials	F25A	F26E	F27E	CAGR
Revenues (M)	12,241	14,296	16,061	14.5%
EBITDA (M)	4,297	5,127	5,890	17.1%

Valuation Metrics	F25A	F26E	F27E
Adjusted P/E (x)	40.5	30.4	24.8
EV/EBITDA (x)	20.8	17.5	15.2

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

See the Disclosure Appendix of this report for required disclosures, analyst certifications and other important information. Alternatively, visit our Global Research Disclosure Website.

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DETAILS

WHAT IS DYNAMIC PRICING?

Dynamic pricing is used in a variety of industries to maximize revenue by adjusting listed prices in response to changing market conditions. As retail has shifted online, adjusting prices has become easier and less costly. Using historical purchase data and real time insights on inventory, traffic and competition, businesses can infer current and future demand curves and set optimal prices accordingly. A variety of industries use dynamic pricing, from airlines and concert ticket vendors to ride-sharing apps and online marketplaces like Amazon.

In the context of vacation rentals, dynamic pricing tools let hosts and property managers adjust the prices on their properties as to maximize their revenue. These tool either recommend or automatically adjust rates in response to a variety of factors.

A dynamic pricing algorithm is likely to consider the following factors:

- **Market Factors**
  - Search volume for the destination - higher search volume for a destination means that properties are subject to higher demand and can therefore charge higher rates
  - Competing supply - the prices and availability of competing supply (i.e. other vacation rental properties, hotel supply) will influence the demand for a vacation rental property influencing the optimal prices to set
  - Events / season - demand for a destination and thereby a property will be driven by events (i.e. a concert or sports event in town) or seasonal demand (i.e. ski chalets during the ski season)
- **Booking Factors**
  - Booking window - prices can be set depending on the time between a search and a stay, with higher prices charged to those booking very early and close to the time of stay
  - Length of stay optimization - prices can be optimized for the number of days a guest is looking to stay at a property
- **Inventory / Property Factors**
  - Gap days - vacant night between longer bookings may warrant discounted pricing
  - Property page views / saves / wishlist's - the level of interest in a particular property indicates demand
  - Property conversion rates - if a property page views are converting into a booking at a very high rate, prices can probably rise

Airbnb has recently started rolling out its new dynamic pricing tool to hosts as part of its fall update; hosts are recommended a pricing range which they can accept in one tap and let the app adjust prices within this range automatically.

SIZING THE IMPACT OF DYNAMIC PRICING

Third-party dynamic pricing services market significant improvements in property revenue. There are a plethora of dynamic pricing services on the market used by vacation rental hosts. These are used by property managers, with some products integrated into property management software like PriceLabs and Guesty, and individual hosts. These services advertise meaningful revenue uplift for hosts, ranging from an 8% to 50% increase driven by both occupancy and ADR gains. On average, the advertised uplift in revenue is ~25% (Exhibit 1).

Airbnb has already benefited from dynamic pricing, but there is room for expansion. With Airbnb's own Smart Pricing and third-party dynamic pricing, the company already benefits from the revenue uplift from dynamic pricing - it captures a take rate on the incremental revenue from hosts using dynamic pricing tools. It is estimated that ~40% of US listings use dynamic pricing, with just 36% of individual hosts using dynamic pricing versus 55% of property managers (Exhibit 2). Adoption of dynamic pricing is likely lower outside the US suggesting a meaningful runway for increasing dynamic pricing penetration with Airbnb's

proprietary service.

If third-party advertising is to be believed, Airbnb's dynamic pricing could drive a M-HSD % tailwind to revenue. We expect Airbnb's dynamic pricing feature to boost host revenue somewhere between 10-40%. Assuming a 25% boost, a 10% increase in dynamic pricing penetration would drive a 230 bps revenue tailwind. If penetration reached 70%, meaning half of those not using full dynamic pricing adopt it, it would contribute ~7% of revenue growth over time (Exhibit 3).

A 3% boost seems more reasonable. We expect that as dynamic pricing adoption increases, the potential revenue gains to hosts are likely to be lower - better pricing across the board will limit the gains to those that do use dynamic pricing. Therefore, if we assume a conservative 10% increase in revenue from Airbnb's product and an increase in dynamic pricing penetration to 70%, Airbnb is set to benefit from a 3% tailwind to revenue (Exhibit 3).

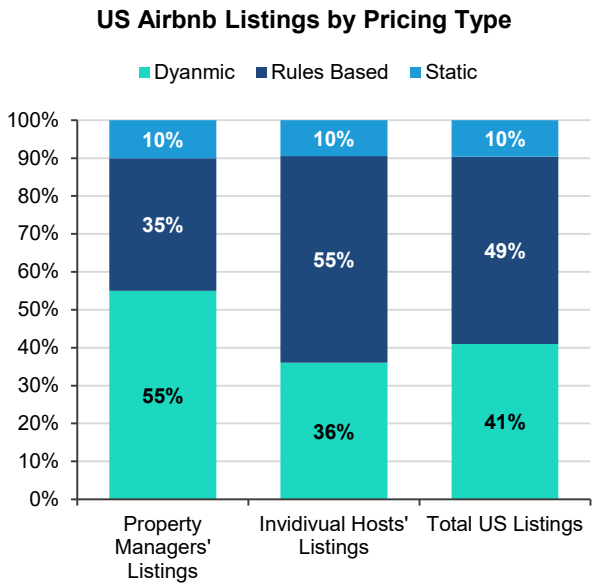
Airbnb's dynamic pricing could outperform competitors. Airbnb is well positioned to deliver a strong dynamic pricing service. They have access to the most data on search traffic and consumer behavior regarding their inventory. For example, they can observe search traffic for a destination, how much traffic a particular property is getting and whether the property has been saved to wishlists or shared with friends. Using this data, Airbnb can better estimate the demand curve associated with each property and thereby set optimal prices. Furthermore, Airbnb will have the most granular and highest volume data on past bookings and current inventory which it can use to forecast booking curves, seasonality and elasticities. Although third party providers have built strong dynamic pricing products, these are unlikely to be able to compete with Airbnb's own offering in the long-run given the company's data moat.

EXHIBIT 1: **There are a range of third-party dynamic pricing service providers. On average, they advertise a ~25% uplift to revenue from implementing dynamic pricing.**

		Advertised Impact	
Service	**ADR**	**Occupancy**	**Revenue / RevPAR**
PriceLabs			+8-15%
Hospitable		+20%	+14.5%
Wheelhouse			+20.6%
RevFactor			+24%
Hostaway	-2.5%	+28.6%	+25.1%
AirROI			+20-40%
Beyond		+12%	+40%
DPGO		+30%	+50%
Average (midpoint)		**Mean**	**27%**
		Median	**25%**

Mean and median of midpoints of given ranges
Source: Company websites, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 2: **Around 40% of US Airbnb listings use dynamic pricing, Property managers, who we estimate make up ~25% of listings, use dynamic pricing more than individual hosts.**



We calculate the implied mix of individual hosts and property manager listings using the dynamic pricing mix given by AirDNA
Source: AirDNA, Bernstein analysis & estimates

EXHIBIT 3: **Roughly 40% of Airbnb properties use dynamic pricing in the US. If this share were to increase to 70% with Airbnb rolling out their own dynamic pricing feature, and it delivered the average revenue uplift advertised by third-party services, it could provide a M-HSD % tailwind to revenue.**

		RevPAR / Revenue uplift						
		+10%	+15%	+20%	+25%	+30%	+35%	+40%
% dynamic	40%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%
	50%	1.0%	1.4%	1.9%	2.3%	2.7%	3.1%	3.4%
	60%	1.9%	2.8%	3.7%	4.5%	5.4%	6.1%	6.9%
	70%	2.9%	4.2%	5.6%	6.8%	8.0%	9.2%	10.3%
	80%	3.8%	5.7%	7.4%	9.1%	10.7%	12.3%	13.8%
	90%	4.8%	7.1%	9.3%	11.4%	13.4%	15.4%	17.2%
	100%	5.8%	8.5%	11.1%	13.6%	16.1%	18.4%	20.7%

Source: Bernstein analysis & estimates

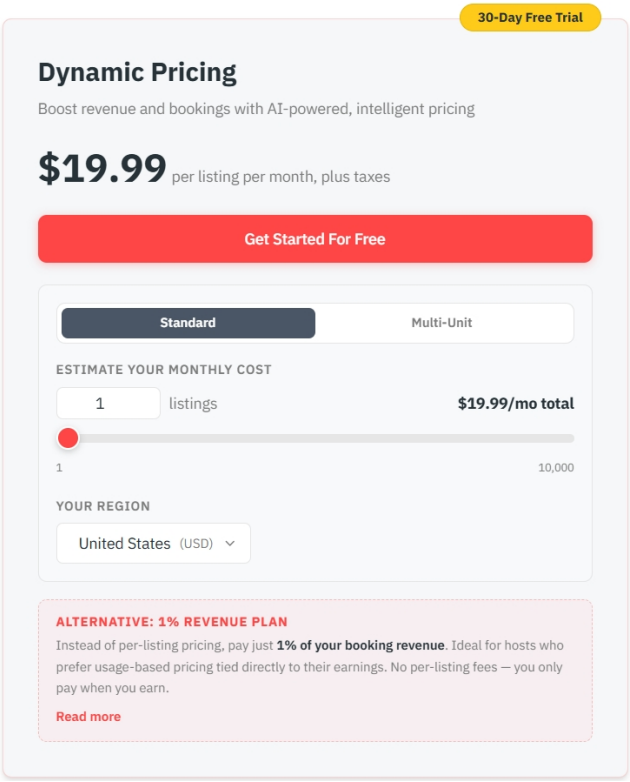
CAN AIRBNB CHARGE FOR DYNAMIC PRICING?

Hosts are willing to pay for dynamic pricing. Vacation rental owners and property managers are clearly willing to pay for dynamic pricing. Most services charge ~$20 per month per listing for dynamic pricing whilst API services targeted at hosts with a large number of properties are able to charge per API call. PriceLabs also offers dynamic pricing in exchange for 1% of hosts' booking revenue (Exhibit 4, Exhibit 5).

Airbnb may be able to charge hosts for its own dynamic pricing service, potentially through higher take rates. Vacation rental hosts are willing to pay for dynamic pricing services given that they deliver higher revenue. If Airbnb is able to provide a compelling proprietary dynamic pricing service, it can charge hosts for this, either through a subscription per property, or by raising take rates over time.

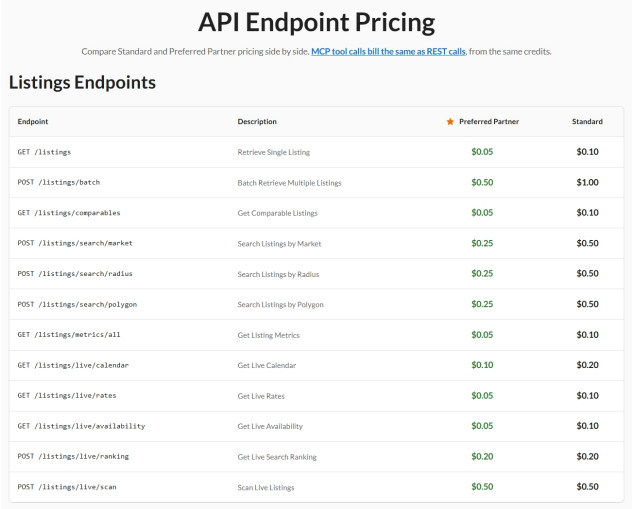
Charging for dynamic pricing could provide a further meaningful revenue tailwind. If Airbnb decided to charge $15 per month per property for dynamic pricing, and 30% of properties opted for their service, it would be a 4% tailwind to revenue (Exhibit 6), whilst a 1% increase in take rates from an improving suite of host tools would be a ~7% tailwind.

EXHIBIT 4: **Price labs charges hosts as much as £20 per listing per month, decreasing if hosts have more than one listing. Alternatively, hosts can pay 1% of booking revenue.**



Source: PriceLabs, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 5: **AirROI operates an API for more sophisticated vacation rental owners, charging $0.05 per recommended price endpoint call**



Source: AirROI, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 6: **If Airbnb charged $20 per night per propety for dynamic pricing, in line with PriceLabs, and 40% of the 9 milllion properties on the platform opted in, it would be a ~7% boost to FY25 revenue**

		% uptake of Airbnb's dynamic pricing				
		10%	20%	30%	40%	50%
Charge per property per month	$5	0.4%	0.9%	1.3%	1.8%	2.2%
	$10	0.9%	1.8%	2.6%	3.5%	4.4%
	$15	1.3%	2.6%	4.0%	5.3%	6.6%
	$20	1.8%	3.5%	5.3%	7.1%	8.8%
	$25	2.2%	4.4%	6.6%	8.8%	11.0%

Source: Company reports, Bernstein analysis & estimates

AIRBNB MOVING TOWARDS A SOFT FRANCHISE MODEL

The more interesting long-term implication is that Airbnb increasingly resembles a hotel franchisor rather than a traditional online travel platform. Today, Airbnb primarily provides demand, connecting hosts with guests in exchange for a commission, much like any Online Travel Agent. Over time, however, the company is steadily expanding into areas that sit much closer to

operating the asset itself. Pricing tools are the clearest example, but they are unlikely to be the last.

The hotel franchise model is built on a simple premise: owners provide the capital and own the real estate, while the brand supplies the operating playbook, technology, revenue management expertise, standards and distribution. The franchisor's objective is not merely to sell rooms, but to help owners maximise the long-term earnings power of the property. Airbnb has the potential to evolve along a similar path. Rather than being a booking channel, it could become the operating layer that helps hosts design, equip, price and manage their homes more effectively.

Such a model would significantly increase Airbnb's importance within the hosting ecosystem. Services such as revenue management, design consultation, property management software, guest communications, cleaning coordination, insurance and smart-home hardware all deepen integration with the asset itself. As each layer is added, Airbnb becomes less of a marketplace and more of a strategic partner to hosts. The relationship shifts from transaction-based to operational, with Airbnb participating more directly in the success of the property.

Importantly, this may also prove to be a more durable model in an AI-driven world. Distribution advantages can erode if AI agents make it easier for consumers to compare inventory across platforms. By contrast, the capabilities that sit behind the listing, namely the tools, expertise and systems that help hosts run their properties, are much harder to replicate or disintermediate. In that sense, Airbnb's long-term opportunity may be less about becoming the best place to book accommodation and more about becoming the essential infrastructure layer for independent accommodation owners, much as Marriott, Hilton and IHG have done for hotel owners.

APPENDIX

Sources for advertised third-party revenue boost:

- PriceLabs - 8-15% RevPAR uplift (here)
- AirROI - Increase annual revenue by 20-40% (here)
- RevFactor - 24% boost to revenue vs comp set (here)
- Beyond - 40% increase in revenue, 12% increase in occupancy, 21% more bookings (here)
- Wheelhouse - 20.6% increase in average revenue (here)
- DPGO - 50% increase in revenue, 30% increase in occupancy rate (here)
- Hospitable - 20% boost to occupancy, 14.5% increase in RevPAR (here)
- Hostaway - 2.5% decrease in ADR, 28.6% increase in occupancy, 25.1% increase in RevPAR (here)

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

			8 Oct 2026		TTM	Adjusted EPS				Adjusted P/E (x)		
			Closing	Price	Rel.							
Ticker	Rating	Cur	Price	Target	Perf.	Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
ABNB (Airbnb)	O	USD	163.23	217.00	21.8%	USD	4.03	5.37	6.58	40.5	30.4	24.8
SPX			7,811.54									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

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VALUATION METHODOLOGY

Airbnb Inc

We value ABNB on a $217 Price Target via (1) an NTM+1 EV/EBITDA multiple, which is a function of sales growth, EBITDA margin and cash conversion - benchmarked against peers, and (2) an NTM+1 P/E multiple. We value Airbnb on a 16x NTM+1 EV/EBITDA multiple (on company defined EBITDA), and a 29x NTM+1 P/E multiple.

RISKS

Airbnb Inc

Downside risks to target price:

- A decline in overall travel demand
- A step change in competition from Google, Booking or Expedia
- A step change in regulation restricting supply

RATINGS DEFINITIONS, BENCHMARKS AND DISTRIBUTION

EQUITY RATINGS DEFINITIONS

Bernstein brand

The Bernstein brand rates stocks based on forecasts of relative performance for the next 12 months versus the S&P 500 for stocks listed on the U.S. and Canadian exchanges, versus the Bloomberg Europe Developed Markets Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index EUR (EDME) for stocks listed on the European exchanges and emerging markets exchanges outside of the Asia Pacific region, versus the Bloomberg Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index USD (JPL) for stocks listed on the Japanese exchanges, and versus the Bloomberg Asia ex-Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index (ASIAX) for stocks listed on the Asian (ex-Japan) exchanges -unless otherwise specified.

The Bernstein brand has three categories of ratings:

- Outperform: Stock will outpace the market index by more than 15 pp
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Bernstein brand stock ratings are based on a 12-month time horizon.

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The Autonomous brand rates common stocks as indicated below. As our benchmarks we use the Bloomberg Europe 600 Financials Price Return Index (E600BK) and Bloomberg Europe Dev Mkt Financials Large and Mid Cap Price Ret Index EUR (EDMFI) index for developed European banks and Payments, the Bloomberg Europe 600 Insurance Price Return Index (E600IN) for European insurers, the S&P 500 and S&P Financials for US banks and Payments coverage, S5LIFE for US Insurance, the S&P Insurance Select Industry (SPSIINS) for US Non-Life Insurers coverage, the Bloomberg Emerging Markets Financials Large, Mid and Small Cap Price Return Index (EMLSF) for emerging market banks and insurers and Payments, and the Bloomberg Japan Financials Large & Mid Cap Price Return Index (JPFILM) for Japanese Financials. Ratings are stated relative to the sector (not the market).

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- Outperform (OP): Stock will outpace the relevant index by more than 10 pp
- Neutral (N): Stock will perform in line with the market index to within +/-10 pp
- Underperform (UP): Stock will trail the performance of the relevant index by more than 10 pp

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Those denoted as 'Feature' (e.g., Feature Outperform FOP, Feature Under Outperform FUP) are our core ideas.

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- Neutral (N): The total return of the preferred instrument is expected to perform in line with preferred securities of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.
- Underperform (UP): The total return of the preferred instrument is expected to underperform preferred securities of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.

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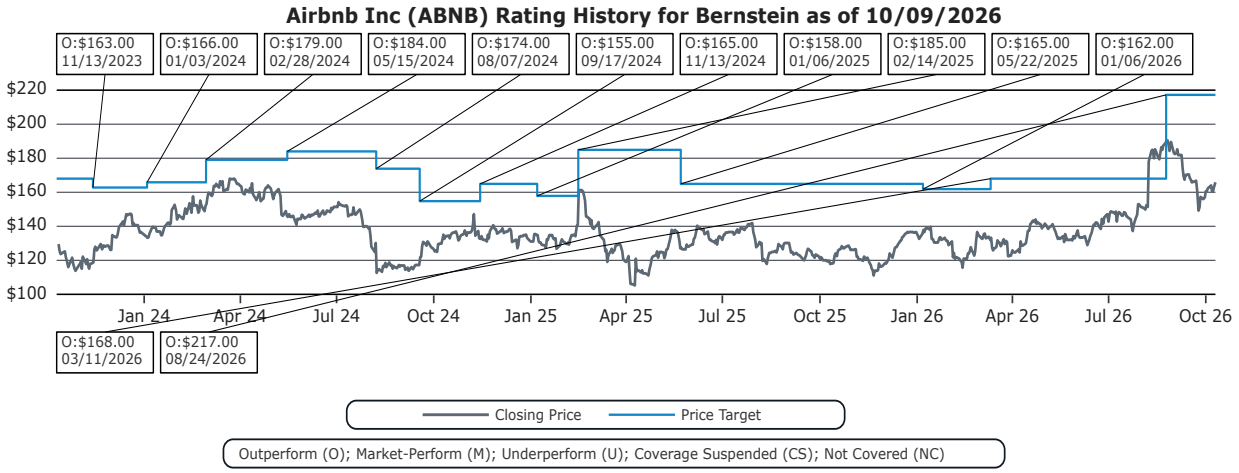
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Equity Rating	Market Abuse Regulation (MAR) and FINRA Rating Category	Global Rating Distribution	Investment Banking Relationships*
Outperform	BUY	52.3%	14.2%
Market-Perform (Bernstein Brand) Neutral (Autonomous Brand)	HOLD	35.6%	16.1%
Underperform	SELL	12.1%	13.6%

* These figures represent the percentage of companies within each equity rating category for which affiliates of Bernstein have provided investment banking services within the previous 12 months.
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